

TEACHING EVALUATIONS
(LAST TWO YEARS)

I. Courses Taught as an Instructor at Boston College (graduate level, unless otherwise specified)

A. Big Data Econometrics

- Fall, 2024* (in person [syl.](#))

B. Econometrics/Regression Methods

- Fall, 2024* (in person [syl.](#))
- [Summer II, 2024](#) (asynchronous [syl.](#)) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 93%)
- [Spring II, 2024](#) (in person) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 93%)
- [Fall, 2023](#) (in person) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 97%)
- [Summer II, 2023](#) (asynchronous) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 96%)
- [Spring II, 2023](#) (in person) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 91%)
- [Fall II, 2022](#) (asynchronous) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 91%)

C. Software Tools for Data Analysis

- [Fall II, 2023](#) (asynchronous [syl.](#)) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 95%)
- [Fall I, 2022](#) (asynchronous) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 93%)

D. Data Analysis

- [Spring II, 2024](#) (asynchronous [syl.](#)) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 87%)
- [Fall, 2023](#) (in person [syl.](#)) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 96%)
- [Spring I, 2023](#) (in person) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 91%)
- [Fall I, 2022](#) (in person) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 87%)

E. Linear Algebra and Vector Calculus/Mathematical Methods for Machine Learning I

- Fall, 2024* (in person [syl.](#))
- [Spring, 2024](#) (in person) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 95%)

F. Directed Practicum

- [Spring, 2024](#) (in-person/online [syl.](#)) (Avg. Score on all Qs.: 93%)
- Fall, 2023 (online) N/A {<5 enrolled students}
- Summer, 2023 (online) N/A {<5 enrolled students}
- Spring, 2023 (online) N/A {<5 enrolled students}

G. Fundamentals of Economics

(summer school)

- Summer II, 2024 (in person [syl.](#))
- [Summer I, 2023](#) (in person)

H. Data Analysis

(summer school)

- Summer III, 2024 (in person [syl.](#))
- [Summer II, 2023](#) (in person)

Econometrics/Regression Methods, Boston College

Summer II 2024 (asynchronous)

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Summary of Teaching Evaluations (Instructor)

	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.47	4.27
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.65	4.37
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.65	4.44
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.82	4.39
The course was well organized.	4.88	4.55
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.65	4.60
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.88	4.41
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.41	4.53
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.65	4.55
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.53	4.53
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	4.76	4.60
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.65	4.56
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.65	4.50
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.35	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.70	N/A
ENROLLMENT	17	
RESPONSE RATE	81%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

All Comments:

I. Strengths of this course

Regression analysis are the main strength in this course. I have learned lot of things in r programming. My professor helped me a lot, so that the way I did my home works and assignments.

Real-world applications, opportunities to practice models on different datasets

Very well designed. Highly engaged facilitator. Timely feedback always provided.

How the assignments were meant to simulate real life scenarios. Each HW assignment had a true purpose and felt like an assignment one would get while on a real job. I really appreciated that and felt like I learned the most from it. Additionally Professor Sharma is the best, always providing very detailed feedback.

I learned how to use different models and apply them.

The strengths were that there was a lot of resources provided and the professor was very responsive to emails as well as making himself available to meet.

learned a lot about regressions and different models

The course was really challenging and had introduce me to new topics and perspectives regarding Econometrics.

Professor Sharma is very responsive, and very involved.

The Course is well organized is really useful in the future.

Detailed / Challenging / Autonomous / Asynchronous

New, challenging material each week.

Econometrics/Regression Methods, Boston College

Summer II 2024 (asynchronous)

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II. What would have improved your learning in the course?

The course had a lot of work to do, something that took 100% of my time during the semester that I had done it. In my perspective maybe to decrease the number of discussions would help to decompress the amount of work in the course.

Slightly less course work. Seems just a tad overpacked with assignments.

nothing, it was perfect.

If I had more time. I was way too busy to complete this course especially in 7 weeks.

Coding knowledge and understand about research articles. Data analytics related topics.

Less volume of assignments and videos. There was so much going on at the same time and always playing catch-up that I couldn't ever get deep into any one assignment

N/A

Nothing. I thought this course was very well organized.

Nothing

I think if there was more time spent on how to actually interpret and comprehend the data, that would have been helpful. I think that there is also enough terms that warranted more time spent on learning what those all meant – although perhaps it was assumed that the terms were learned in another class.

explain more R, give more guidance on homework and discussion

A different structure of weekly assignments, too many discussion boards, and projects had overlap.

III. Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

Yes he did. I cannot recommend Professor Sharma enough. He posted so many helpful materials to help students on complex HW assignments and was always available for help. He additionally provided so much detail on HW assignments, even when you did well on an assignment. It was never just “good job” or “can improve here”, he gave detailed comments so the students can learn as much as possible.

absolutely – this was also reiterated in the syllabus as well as in lectures.

yes, he created an open and respectful environment

Yes, he did. He was very supportive and responsive.

For sure! He is excellent.

Yes through discussion posts

Great facilitator who is proactive and cares about learning outcomes.

Yes

IV. Additional Comments:

I want to thank professor Sharma for been open to talk and to provide extensions as necessary for the assignments.

Videos released sunday at midnight make staying on top of things almost impossible. If the volume of assignments remains so high, then it would be more fair to grade on a quicker turn around. Otherwise, I'm submitting the next assignment before I've gotten feedback on the first assignment and continuing to make the same mistakes

The group projects are great, but challenging to manage in this online modality.

Nothing additional. 10/10 with Professor Sharma.

I greatly appreciate Professor Sharma and he is extremely knowledgeable in this area. I also appreciated that he was very understanding and helpful – he truly supported the students and wanted each one to be successful.

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Econometrics/Regression Methods, Boston College

Spring II 2024 (in person)

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Summary of Teaching Evaluations (Instructor)

	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.50	4.30
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.50	4.42
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.25	4.47
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.50	4.49
The course was well organized.	4.75	4.57
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.75	4.59
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.75	4.41
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.50	4.53
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.75	4.55
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.75	4.58
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	5.00	4.57
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.75	4.60
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.75	4.55
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.50	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.50	N/A
ENROLLMENT	7	
RESPONSE RATE	57%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

All Comments:

I. Strengths of this course

This course covered **quasi experimental methods** that I found extremely **useful, interesting, and relevant** to future careers/job opportunities I hope to pursue.

II. What would have improved your learning in the course?

Generally I felt my time and effort in this course was not always necessary or rewarded. It was frustrating because if everyone in the class was encouraged (or required) to attend class in person (despite it being an advertised on campus course) – I would have learned a lot more and would have benefited from the perspectives of my peers. The majority of the time I was one of only one or two other classmates who came to the lectures, so discussion and participation was very limited which was disappointing because I have taken many other in person or hybrid courses where the classroom environment was extremely collaborative.

III. Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

Professor Sharma was generally respectful, I did not always align with his side commentary or sense of humor but that was fine.

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Econometrics/Regression Methods, Boston College

Fall 2023 (in person)

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Summary of Teaching Evaluations (Instructor)

	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.80	4.43
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.80	4.30
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.72	4.45
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.73	4.46
The course was well organized.	4.80	4.45
The learning objectives were clearly defined	5.00	4.46
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.80	4.42
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.80	4.52
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.79	4.59
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.48	4.58
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	5.00	4.56
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	5.00	4.60
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	5.00	4.56
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.80	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	5.00	N/A
ENROLLMENT	11	
RESPONSE RATE	45%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

Select Comments:

I. Strengths of this course

The **breadth of material** learned helped grow my understanding of the topic.

Constant discussions, and practicing the **applications** of information learned in class, helped to reinforce the new information.

Its focus on **coding** was extremely helpful and has helped me gain proficiency in R above what I expected. The **lessons** were **engaging** and taught me much more than what I thought I would. Overall, there are **no distinct weaknesses** of the course.

Excellent professor!

II. What would have improved your learning in the course?

While the **introduction** to many econometric concepts and methods was **great**, I think it may have been better to focus more closely on a smaller number.

III. Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

Yes, they were very helpful and always willing to extend help outside of class.

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Econometrics/Regression Methods, Boston College

Summer II 2023 (asynchronous)

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Summary of Teaching Evaluations (Instructor)

	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.60	4.34
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	5.00	4.41
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	5.00	4.43
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	5.00	4.43
The course was well organized.	4.80	4.62
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.80	4.66
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.80	4.49
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.60	4.55
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.60	4.62
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.80	4.56
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	5.00	4.59
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	5.00	4.60
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	5.00	4.58
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.40	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	5.00	N/A
ENROLLMENT	5	
RESPONSE RATE	100%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

Select Comments:

I. Strengths of this course

Concepts presented in the Class are **interesting** and **important**

The course is **very well organized** and easy to engage with. As a student, all of the necessary **learning materials** were **provided** and **outlined**, and there was **a lot of support** from the instructor in ensuring that progress was made throughout the semester.

The assignments really help students get a better grasp on learning both econometrics in general but also R. I'd like to highlight that Dr. Sharma does a great job of **providing detailed, helpful feedback** that we as students could reference throughout the course to help strengthen our performance on each successive assignment. He also makes himself available to students to provide feedback in person on term projects, homework, etc. that I found very helpful.

II. What would have improved your learning in the course?

N/A – I really enjoyed the way the course was structured as is

III. Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

Absolutely – Dr. Sharma is **effective at communicating** and making sure that all **students are engaged** with the course on a week to week basis, even in an online and asynchronous environment. Dr. Sharma frequently kept students up to date with weekly emails and announcements around important deadlines and updates, while providing forums for students to discuss concepts amongst themselves.

Absolutely – Dr. Sharma is a great professor and goes out of his way to help his students. He provides **meaningful, detailed feedback** on assignments and you can tell that he really **wants his students to succeed both in an academic environment and professionally**.

Professor was **very helpful** and willing to **answer all questions** and **teach material...** even given the challenges of a Asynchronous Class structure.

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Summary of Teaching Evaluations (**Instructor**)

	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.29	4.20
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.43	4.33
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.57	4.41
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.71	4.40
The course was well organized.	4.43	4.50
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.57	4.52
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.57	4.40
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.57	4.47
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.71	4.52
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.43	4.53
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	4.71	4.53
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.71	4.55
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.71	4.47
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.14	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.57	N/A
ENROLLMENT	11	
RESPONSE RATE	64%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

Select Comments:**I. Strengths of this course**

Good teacher

the **explanation** and **application** of different **models**

We have a 3 homeassignment for the practices which is helpful to master the necessary knowledges.

Well **organized**, short but precise on the knowledge provided.

Challenging. Could use in future work

You can learn real world cases and produce **meaningful research paper** which can help us in the future **career**.

Assignments taught us of **real world applications** and they were extremely intriguing

II. Additional Comments:

I was taught by Professor Arvind Sharma. He always went the **extra mile** to be of **assistance** even during weekend.

III. Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

of course– very open to helping students **outside** of class

Yes, Professor Sharma treat all students with respect, and **class environment** is **great**.

Yes, Professor Sharma is a **polite** and responsible gentleman. Always **help** me when I need.

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Econometrics/Regression Methods, Boston College

Fall II 2022 (asynchronous)

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Summary of Teaching Evaluations (Instructor)

	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.00	4.27
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.33	4.42
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.00	4.46
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.67	4.49
The course was well organized.	4.67	4.55
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.75	4.58
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.83	4.45
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.33	4.49
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.75	4.55
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.50	4.58
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	5.00	4.60
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.83	4.61
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.67	4.56
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.17	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.67	N/A
ENROLLMENT	12	
RESPONSE RATE	50%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

Select Comments:

I. Strengths of this course

This course is **incredibly challenging** but, also, one of the **more practical courses** I have taken in this program. The course content flows logically from ADEC7310 (Dat Analysis) and builds on previously learned skills.

Professor **encouraged new skills**, and the **projects and homework** were **rewarding**

The professor was always **available to help** and answer any questions.

The assignments and project let me **practice** my R skills

II. What would have improved your learning in the course?

Additional lecture time/additional pre-recorded lecture material. Lecture material **focuses heavily on theory** and not much on using R to analyze data. If each lesson were accompanied by a practical walkthrough in R it would be very useful (supplemental Youtube videos are linked, but are not as useful as learning the code directly from professor).

The course is very **condensed**, I do not like 7 week courses.

III. Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

Absolutely. AS was very **respectful** to all students, **encouraged** and **challenged** the class and was very flexible/willing to meet with students to work on research papers and to provide additional help.

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	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.45	4.30
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.67	4.43
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.44	4.45
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.78	4.46
The course was well organized.	4.82	4.55
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.91	4.56
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.91	4.42
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.71	4.37
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.91	4.59
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.80	4.58
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	4.90	4.56
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.80	4.60
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.67	4.56
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.78	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.56	N/A
ENROLLMENT	21	
RESPONSE RATE	52%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

Select Comments:

I. Strengths of this course

I learned a lot of **practical skills** in a short period of time and I have made **great progress in visualization**.

Provided opportunities to learn **necessary analytics tool**.

- 1) Professor Sharma – Excellent professor who went above and beyond to help his students. He was incredibly **responsive**, always **willing** to answer questions, and effectively broke down complex topics into more **digestible chunks**.
- 2) Discussions – **Thought provoking** prompts which strongly reinforce the course material.
- 3) Homework – **Challenging but enriching**. Allows students to immediately test their skills on real world data and effectively prepares them to work with programming tools.

II. What would have improved your learning in the course?

The R part is difficult for beginners. I didn't learn it very well. Maybe the content is a bit difficult.

My r programming skills

III. Additional Comments:

The inclusion of a Python module might be beneficial to future students.

IV. Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

He is **always eager** to help students and **responds promptly**!

Yes. Instructor cultivated an open and welcominh environment in class.

Software Tools for Data Analysis, Boston College

Fall I 2022 (asynchronous)

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Summary of Teaching Evaluations (Instructor)

	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.29	4.30
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.43	4.42
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.29	4.47
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.43	4.49
The course was well organized.	4	4.57
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.29	4.59
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.29	4.41
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.57	4.53
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.29	4.55
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.43	4.58
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	4.29	4.57
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.29	4.60
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.43	4.55
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.29	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.43	N/A
ENROLLMENT	7	
RESPONSE RATE	100%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

Select Comments:

I. Strengths of this course

Arvind has been an **excellent facilitator** who takes his responsibilities seriously and professionally. It was interesting watching him from afar manage this group of students given the varying levels of experience, education and engagement. He's a winner. I'm **better at my craft given this course**, personally and professionally.

The professor helps to teach coding in some of the **best video lectures** I have ever seen. The videos clearly show time and commitment by the professor, as they are very easy to follow, and he highlights and circles the important part as he goes. On top of being great videos, the way he teaches within the videos is extremely helpful and done in a way that is easy to understand. I have struggled with coding in the past and while I won't say I am an expert by any means, I will say **my skills are leaps and bounds better compared to the start of this course**.

The instructor presented the material in a **clear and concise manner**. Arvind was also **readily available on-demand** to address questions even during late hours, exemplary work!

The professor did an **outstanding job**. He responded to emails very quickly, and was **understanding and helpful** when you asked him questions.

The assignments allow for new **opportunities to learn new softwares**

The **layout** of the videos used to teach the different software programs is **excellent**. The professor is very **dedicated** and works incredibly hard to make sure that his **students understand the material**. I cannot emphasize enough how well Dr. Sharma taught this course.

The professor made himself well available for office hours. Moreover, he **showed a general interest in us learning the material**.

I really appreciate that Dr. Sharma promptly replied to my emails and went to such great lengths to meet with me over zoom. He also **spent a great deal of time** over zoom **giving** me and other **students much needed** instruction/information.

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	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.57	4.30
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.71	4.43
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.86	4.45
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.86	4.46
The course was well organized.	4.86	4.55
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.86	4.46
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.86	4.42
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.86	4.52
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.71	4.59
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.86	4.58
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	4.86	4.35
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.86	4.60
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.86	4.56
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.57	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.57	N/A
ENROLLMENT	14	
RESPONSE RATE	50%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

Select Comments:

I. Strengths of this course

Really everything for me. This was probably my favorite course I have ever taken so far. Each chapter/module had both assignments and discussions that really helped students fully grasp the material. Each type of assignment had a good range of questions to allow us to fully grasp the material from that week. Additionally, every assignment also had extremely helpful links to allow us to learn even further from our weekly lectures. An example of this would be when we learned about distributions and we had additional links on the distributions themselves but also how to apply them to R. This included different types of graphs, shading graphs, and other helpful notes.

Arvind provided lots of extra reading and resources to help our learning, he also kept it applicable to the real world and tried to give us real-world examples.

clearly code description, useful discussion assignments

II. Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

For me personally, it was a lot of information and was very challenging. It took 10+ hours each week and the final exams were challenging to complete in the allotted time. I understand it's a condensed course and we have to fit a lot into a couple of weeks. If possible, I'd suggest reducing the scope of the course a bit to be more manageable, spending more time on the foundations of R. But I learned a lot.

None, I loved this course

more pdf of lecture notes

N/A

III. **Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?**

yes, everyone respect each other

Yes. Professor Sharma was fantastic. On top of weekly lectures, he had optional meetups weekly and office hours. He gave the students so much information to be able to succeed. His lectures were great and on top of that he constantly helped provide us links to assist in applying topics to R. As someone who had not used statistical programming software's before, Professor Sharma helped me feel so much more comfortable using and apply topics we learned to it. I could not recommend him enough.

N/A

Yes, Arvind was kind and empathetic towards students and understanding of help and questions.

IV. **Additional Comments**

N/A

Arvind is a great professor! Despite it being quite rigorous, I enjoyed being in the class and learning. I feel like I am a better data analyst because of it.

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	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.57	4.30
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.71	4.43
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.86	4.45
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.86	4.46
The course was well organized.	4.86	4.55
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.86	4.46
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.86	4.42
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.86	4.52
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.71	4.59
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.86	4.58
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	4.86	4.35
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.86	4.60
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.86	4.56
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.57	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.57	N/A
ENROLLMENT	14	
RESPONSE RATE	50%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

Select Comments:

I. Strengths of this course

Professor Sharma was a great instructor all semester long. I came into the course not knowing any **computer programming** and now feel very comfortable in R. The discussion assignments each week did a great job at **solidifying concepts** in class the week before. The homework assignments were also great at expanding **concepts** and **applying** them. I thought the course was very fair and rewarding. The canvas site also had **numerous resources** to use to extra information and help on any topic. I definitely would recommend this course taught by Prof. Sharma to anyone. He really **cares** about his students.

Prof. Sharma did a great job in this course. I really **learned** and **improved on my skills** a lot from the beginning of the semester.

Really **enjoyed** the class and would recommend professor Sharma to anyone.

The focus on the **implementation of R** into data analysis.

Professor Sharma was excellent, very very smart and understanding. The discussions and HW assignments **help tie** what we are learning in **class** and helped me **practice**. Having the lectures online also offered flexibility for days I had work obligations, flexibility was appreciated.

This class helps me **understand** rstudio **better**

Professor Arvind Sharma is good

II. Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

Yes, Prof. Sharma was always treated everyone with the **upmost respect** and had a very **welcoming environment** in class. He was always available and took his time to get to know each and everyone of us.

He was very **respectful** to all and made class **enjoyable**

	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.40	4.04
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.60	4.16
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.70	4.28
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.90	4.32
The course was well organized.	4.40	4.47
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.10	4.40
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.50	4.39
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.70	4.37
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.20	4.44
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.60	4.41
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	5.00	4.35
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.50	4.45
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.50	4.34
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.10	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.70	N/A
ENROLLMENT	13	
RESPONSE RATE	77%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

Select Comments:

V. Strengths of this course

The course provided the **fundamentals for more advanced courses** like Regression models and it gave me a **clear understanding** on the subjects that I have to enroll for the subsequent semesters.

Theorems are tied to actual code which is helpful for learning.

Was challenging but many **concepts were explained well**.

learn the basics of R studio, understand what you are doing in **R**, learn **from peers**

I gained knowledge on **principles of statistics** and basic plus refreshing of knowledge on **algebra and calculus**. It is a fundamental course for the next level of econometrics and other machine learning languages.

Statistical content and the fact that we've to apply all of it

The professor makes going to **class enjoyable**.

Programing language is the future trend. I always want to learn a coding course, and so far I learned **a lot of skills** from this course.

VI. What would have improved your learning in the course?

Nothing could have been better, **everything is perfect**.

maybe knowing a little bit of R before starting the course. The first couple weeks were overwhelming but once I got the hang of it, it was much better

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It helped me to gain knowledge on every line of these courses. I learned R language and other relevant statistics theorems and Regression analysis.

In the course, I learned some basic skills which are very important in the R language.

A longer duration, so the concepts are more digestible for R beginners. It would be better if the classroom learnings were more directly applied, concepts and practical R coding could be better integrated.

I think had the course been a bit lengthy, it would have helped more since people with no prior knowledge in coding have a hard start

Discussion posts don't encourage a lot of genuine discussion.

*The **course is perfect**. Maybe a little bit tight being only half of the semester.*

VII. Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

*I don't know how to describe Prof. Arvind Sharma. He is simply a super-talented, excellent instructor who understands the **students' pulse** and teaches the classes accordingly, and keeps the class more interesting way and **interactively** (lively). The reason is, I am the perfect example. I am studying the courses after a long break and he patiently explains every question and spends the time in his off hours also. He has very good knowledge of the subject and easily mingles with students and keeps the class very interesting.*

*Professor Sharma is really nice professor. He is kind, **respectful**, and **patient** with all the students.*

*He treated all the students **equally** and he **engaged** the class by asking questions and giving good examples for each and every topic to make it interesting to learn.*

*Yes, Dr. Arvind is very **accepting** and is dedicated to his job. He's always willing to stay behind and answer any questions, even to the point of staying up till midnight before an assignment was due.*

VIII. Additional Comments

*Prof. Arvind Sharma had been **really helpful** in addressing all my questions and he clarified all the doubts in a timely manner. He provided comments for each and every question where I committed a mistake, this helped me in **rectifying my mistake so that I would not repeat them again**.*

*Arvind is **awesome**!*

*This is **precise** and excellent. Don't add any more stuff.*

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Summary of Teaching Evaluations (**Instructor**)

	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.00	4.04
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.20	4.16
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.60	4.28
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.80	4.32
The course was well organized.	4.20	4.47
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.00	4.40
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.00	4.39
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.40	4.37
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.40	4.44
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.40	4.41
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	5.00	4.35
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.00	4.45
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.40	4.34
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.40	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.20	N/A
ENROLLMENT	8	
RESPONSE RATE	75%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

Select Comments:**I. Strengths of this course**

The instructor **explains the lesson** and goes over in a manner that is **easy to understand**

The instructor **takes time to post** messages of **what may have been missed** in class.

Dr Sharma is very **helpful**.

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Linear Algebra and Vector Calculus/Math Methods for Machine Learning, Boston College

Spring 2024 (in person)

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Summary of Teaching Evaluations (Instructor)

	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.54	4.30
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.85	4.42
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.77	4.47
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.92	4.49
The course was well organized.	4.62	4.57
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.69	4.59
The course was intellectually challenging.	4.54	4.41
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.62	4.53
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.69	4.55
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.70	4.58
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	4.77	4.57
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.77	4.60
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.77	4.55
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.70	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.85	N/A
ENROLLMENT	17	
RESPONSE RATE	77%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

All Comments:

I. Strengths of this course

Arvind always recorded the class video so i can review it again and again. Linear algebra is abstract and 3D image helps a lot.

Breadth of material covered.

Help me systematically learn linear algebra and machine learning related theories.

Professor Sharma did a great job conveying what were the focal points of the learning, helping to understand which subjects were important to master for the following coursework versus what was more peripheral topics.

The course is very helpful and opened my eyes to practical application of vector calculus.

NA

Organized structure, discussion and quiz.

Dr. Arvind

N/A

II. What would have improved your learning in the course?

All good.

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Faster pace of learning was sometimes desired. Course tended to dwell on certain topics. I appreciated the thoroughness at times, particularly when the concepts were especially abstract. When the material was more basic (i.e., first few weeks), the pace could have been faster. I think students should be expected to learn certain basic material on their own time.

I need to understand more about the principle behind the formula.

Professor was awesome, a great teacher and super helpful. However, there were a few points where things could've been a little more clearly followed

NA

—

N/A

III. Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

Very nice.

Absolutely. Professor Sharma creates an environment where questions are encouraged.

Yes. Professor Sharma is very nice to everybody in the course. I really enjoy the time.

Absolutely, everyone was always treated with respect.

Yes, always trying to drive a discussion and encourage questions

He is the best!

Yes

N/A

IV. Additional Comments:

Great course, 10/10

NA

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N/A

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Directed Practicum, Boston College
Spring 2024 (in person)
 Summary of Teaching Evaluations (**Instructor**)

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	Section Avg.	Dept. Avg. (all courses)
How would you rate this course overall?	4.43	4.30
How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?	4.43	4.42
I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.86	4.47
I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments	4.71	4.49
The course was well organized.	4.86	4.57
The learning objectives were clearly defined	4.86	4.59
The course was intellectually challenging.	5	4.41
Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.	4.57	4.53
I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.	4.71	4.55
The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.	4.71	4.58
The instructor was available for help outside of class.	4.86	4.57
The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.	4.57	4.60
The instructor motivated me to do my best work.	4.57	4.55
How likely are you to recommend this course to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.29	N/A
How likely are you to recommend this faculty member, Professor Arvind Sharma, to a friend/classmate/colleague?	4.29	N/A
ENROLLMENT	7	
RESPONSE RATE	100%	

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

All Comments:

I. Strengths of this course

These course teach us how to write a research paper of the economy or related topic. Professor Sharma gives me lots of details about what the formal academic paper should have.

Apply the theoretical knowledge learned to practical data applications

The autonomy to take it the direction you want to.

Independence

I think this course taught me a lot of skills that will be useful going forward; having worked on a large project from start to finish was very informative. From data organization to the creation of a research question this course taught me a lot about how to do research

II. What would have improved your learning in the course?

good

Less focused on the modeling aspect.

More structure.

Maybe a group zoom call half way through the course where students could talk to each other about their progress.

III. *Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?*

yes, Professor Sharma always response the email in time and he would solve all the questions from the students with best he can.

yes

Yes

Yes!

Yes, He did a great job of being understanding and helping students to cultivate their ideas

IV. *Additional Comments:*

Arvind is a fantastic professor who is thoughtful, and helpful in guiding students in their research projects.

Good

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Part of [BC Experience](#) Program for High School Students.

	Section Avg.
The instructor was organized, well prepared, and used class time efficiently.	4.50
The instructor was approachable, communicated clearly, and encouraged students to participate in class.	4.33
The instructor's teaching methods aided my learning and stimulated my interest in the subject matter.	4.33
The course workload and the time spent on assignments were what I expected.	2.00
The course was well-organized and easy to navigate in Canvas.	5.00
Classmates were engaged, interested, and actively participated in class (discussions, peer feedback, etc.).	3.00
ENROLLMENT	21
RESPONSES	6

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

All Comments:

I. **Favorite Part of the course**

learning new things

Learning about monopolies.

*There was a lot of **real life applicability** in the course.*

the professor and learning from him.

Watching the movie at the end.

learning micro economics

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Part of [BC Experience](#) Program for High School Students.

	Section Avg.
The instructor was organized, well prepared, and used class time efficiently.	4.65
The instructor was approachable, communicated clearly, and encouraged students to participate in class.	4.86
The instructor's teaching methods aided my learning and stimulated my interest in the subject matter.	4.60
The course workload and the time spent on assignments were what I expected.	3.11
The course was well-organized and easy to navigate in Canvas.	4.10
Classmates were engaged, interested, and actively participated in class (discussions, peer feedback, etc.).	4.37
ENROLLMENT	14
RESPONSES	4

Note – Scores range from 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree/poor, 3 is uncertain/good, and 5 is strongly agree/excellent.

All Comments:

I. ***Favorite Part of the course***

Working as a group doing the project

*Other students were nice and the amount of work was adequate. The instructor was very **understanding**.*

Group Project and coding in R

The final project where we found patterns in baseball data.